

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 7 3
 ♥ 6 5
 ♦ 9 7 6
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ Q 10 9

♥ A Q J 3

♦ A 10 8

♣ Q J 6



♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ 8 4 2

♦ 5 4 2

♣ 7 4

♠ 4

♥ K 10 9 7

♦ K Q J 3

♣ A K 8 5

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♣7

North opens 1NT.

You have another big hand. And with a 4-card Major you start with 2♣. Partner answers 2♥ and it's your turn again.

What with your singleton ♠ you certainly have enough points for slam. But since it's possible partner has only one Ace you check with Blackwood. Partner says 5♥ and you say . . . What?

Missing one Ace you bid 6♥.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K Q 4 2

♥ J 10 7 6

♦ 7 5

♣ 9 3

♠ J 7 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q 9 8 4

♣ 5 4 2



♠ 9 5

♥ K Q 9 5

♦ A K 6 3

♣ K Q 8

♠ 10 8 6

♥ 4 3

♦ J 10 2

♣ A J 10 7 6

East opens 1NT.

This may go against your instincts, but if you're going to play Stayman then you should follow the rules. Granted that you have a great ♠ suit, you also have 4 ♥s. And when you have a 4-card Major you use Stayman. You bid 2♣ and partner says 2♥.

That is why you used Stayman - to uncover a 4-4 Major suit fit. Having done so you know that you will play in ♥s and you have enough points to bid game. You bid 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♦J

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7
 ♥ A 8 4 3
 ♦ K Q J 2
 ♣ J 4 2

♠ 10 8 6

♥ K Q 5

♦ A 8 6 4

♣ A K 10



♠ 9 5 3

♥ 9 2

♦ 10 9 3

♣ Q 8 7 6 5

♠ A K Q 4 2

♥ J 10 7 6

♦ 7 5

♣ 9 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♦K			

North opens 1NT.

Yes, this is the same hand as Deal 8. Again you bid 2♣. This time partner says 2♦.

You need to describe your hand clearly to partner with this bid. You want to show a game-forcing hand (11 points or more) with 4♥s and 5♠s. You do that by now jumping to 3♠.

If partner had just 2♠s he would have bid 3NT. Since he has 3♠s he bids 4♠.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ K J

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ Q 5 3

♠ 8 7

♥ 8 7 4

♦ K J 9 2

♣ K 9 6 2



♠ K 10 4 2

♥ A Q 10 9 6 3

♦ —

♣ 8 7 4

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 10 8 5 3

♣ A J 10

West

1NT

2♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♥4

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♣

4♠

South

Pass

West opens 1NT.

Even when you hold a 6-card Major, if you have 4 cards in the other Major you use Stayman. Partner answers 2♠.

You've found an 8-card Major fit and you know there are enough points for game. So you bid 4♠.

Yes, but you already knew you had an 8-card ♥ fit since partner's 1NT promised at least 2 ♥s. In fact, you could play game in either Major. However, it is often better to play in a 4-4 fit rather than a 5-3 or 6-2. This hand shows why. Played in ♥s you will make exactly 10 tricks with any opening lead. Played in ♠s you will again make 10 tricks when the defenders start with their 3 ♣ winners. If they start with anything else you are very likely to make 1 or 2 overtricks by discarding dummy losers on your ♥ suit.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 5

♥ 7 4

♦ A K 8 2

♣ A K 10 9

♠ K 10 4 2

♥ A Q 10 9 6 3

♦ —

♣ 8 7 4



♠ 7 6 3

♥ 8 5 2

♦ J 10 9 5 3

♣ J 2

♠ A Q J

♥ K J

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ Q 6 5 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♣J

This is the follow-up to Deal 10. South opens 1NT.

Just like the previous deal with a 4-card Major you use Stayman. This time partner says 2♦. Your turn again.

With partner showing no 4-card Major the bidding takes a turn. With your 6♥s you are sure of an 8-card fit in the suit. With 11 points you must be sure of reaching game. So you bid 4♥.

In this case the strong hand does not become declarer, but the contract is the right one anyway.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

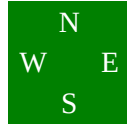
♠ 8 3
 ♥ K Q 7 4
 ♦ 7 6 4 3
 ♣ A 8 2

♠ A J 9

♥ J 9 8 5

♦ K 10 2

♣ 9 6 3



♠ K 10 4 2

♥ A 3

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ K Q 7

♠ Q 7 6 5

♥ 10 6 2

♦ A 8

♣ J 10 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♥6

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♣.

Partner has commanded you to bid a 4-card Major if you have one. You have one, so you bid 2♠. Partner now says 2NT.

Partner evidently has 4 ♥s. He also evidently has about 9 points since he is INVITING you to bid 3NT. With your minimum 15 points you decline the invitation by passing.